

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 302

By Clemmons

A RESOLUTION to recognize Pat Nolan of NewsChannel 5 on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we should honor a journalist who has performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout his career; and

WHEREAS, a Tennessee broadcasting legend, Pat Nolan has appeared on the airwaves of NewsChannel 5 (WTVF) in Nashville in some capacity for more than fifty years, and he will take his much-deserved retirement in March; and

WHEREAS, a lifelong Nashvillian, Pat Nolan graduated from Father Ryan High School in 1969 and earned a Bachelor of Arts degree in Political Science with a minor in History from Vanderbilt University in 1973; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Nolan began his distinguished journalism career at WPLN News in 1973 and was recruited to join NewsChannel 5 as a reporter in 1975 by legendary anchor and news director Chris Clark; and

WHEREAS, after ten years with NewsChannel 5, Mr. Nolan left the station in 1985 to become Nashville Mayor Richard Fulton's executive assistant and press secretary; when Mayor Fulton's term ended in 1987, Mr. Nolan returned to NewsChannel5 and served as its on-air political analyst for more than thirty-one years, from 1987 to 1992 and from 1999 to 2005; and

WHEREAS, he went on to work full time in public relations, working at Hart & Company, Dye Van Mol & Lawrence, and finally DVL Seigenthaler, where he rose to the rank of senior vice president of public relations and advertising before retiring from that post in 2019; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Nolan also served as the anchor/announcer for live television coverage of the Metropolitan Nashville Council meetings from 1973 to 1975 and later from 2019 to 2023; and

WHEREAS, in 2006, he began hosting *Inside Politics* on NewsChannel 5+, a long-running weekly political interview program that originated as *Inside this Week with Chris Clark*, with Mr. Nolan taking over upon Mr. Clark's retirement from broadcasting; and

WHEREAS, over the years, Mr. Nolan has interviewed politicians, state leaders, mayors, councilmembers, lobbyists, historians, experts, analysts, and people of all backgrounds for his show. He is known for thoroughly researching and crafting his questions, then trying to fit in as many of his questions as possible; and

WHEREAS, although Pat Nolan is retiring as both NewsChannel 5's political analyst and host of *Inside Politics*, he has indicated that he is still willing to do interviews about political stories even after his retirement; and

WHEREAS, an active part of his community, he has served on several civic and education boards, including as a founding member of the Father Ryan High School Board of Trust, where he completed four-year tenures as chair and vice chair and served on the Executive Committee; and

WHEREAS, he was also a founding member of the Board of Trust at Saint Bernard Academy (SBA) when a parent-led group purchased SBA from the Sisters of Mercy in 1989. He attended St. Bernard from kindergarten through fifth grade, and his two daughters, Katie and Kelly, are both graduates of Saint Bernard and Father Ryan; and

WHEREAS, sharing his time and talents, he rendered sterling service as a member of the Metro Nashville Historical Commission and the Community Television Access Board; and

WHEREAS, devoted to his family, Mr. Nolan enjoys the love and support of his wife of nearly fifty-one years, Betty Lee Nolan, their children, and grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, Pat Nolan exemplifies the spirit and allegiance to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, throughout his estimable career, Pat Nolan has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the unbridled respect and admiration of his colleagues and the viewing public; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we extend to Pat Nolan our heartfelt wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement and every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.